

RITIK KHANTWAL



TRAINING SYSTEM 09

The 3-Day Executive Workout

Three sessions a week. Full 2–4 minute rests between sets, because that's what actually builds strength. The minimum effective dose for someone whose calendar is not their own.

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Fitness & performance for Indian professionals

Edition 2026

Three days is not a compromise

Three full-body sessions a week, done consistently for a year, beat five sessions done for six weeks and abandoned. This isn't the beginner version of a real programme. For a working professional, it is the real programme.

Every muscle gets trained three times a week instead of once, which is better for strength and better for muscle. Every session is self-contained, so if you only make two that week you've still trained everything. Budget an hour, take your full rests, and do it three times — that beats five rushed sessions every time.

The structure

Session	Focus	Duration
Day 1 — Squat	Full body, knee-dominant lower	55–65 min
Day 2 — Hinge	Full body, hip-dominant lower	55–65 min
Day 3 — Carry & press	Full body, upper emphasis	55–65 min

Ideal spacing is Monday / Wednesday / Friday or Tuesday / Thursday / Saturday, but the rotation matters more than the days. Do them in order whenever you get there.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

Rest 2–4 minutes between sets. Every set. Exercises are still paired (A1/A2) so you alternate between them — but the gap before you repeat the same exercise must be a full 2–4 minutes. Nearer 4 on the heavy A-pair, nearer 2 on the C-pair. Bring a timer; guessing always ends up short.

The five-minute warm-up

- 2 min brisk walk or cycle
- 10 leg swings per leg, front-to-back and side-to-side
- 10 band pull-aparts
- 10 bodyweight squats
- One light set of the first exercise

The three sessions

Day 1 — Squat

	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest
A1	Back or goblet squat	4 × 6–8	2–3 min
A2	Chest-supported row	4 × 10–12	2–3 min
B1	Incline dumbbell press	3 × 8–10	2–3 min
B2	Romanian deadlift	3 × 10	2–3 min
C1	Cable lateral raise	3 × 15	2 min
C2	Hanging knee raise	3 × 12	2 min

Day 2 — Hinge

	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest
A1	Trap-bar or conventional deadlift	4 × 5	3–4 min
A2	Pull-up or lat pulldown	4 × 6–10	2–3 min
B1	Bulgarian split squat	3 × 8 per leg	2–3 min
B2	Seated shoulder press	3 × 8–10	2–3 min
C1	Face pull	3 × 15	2 min
C2	Hammer curl	3 × 12	2 min

Day 3 — Carry & press

	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest
A1	Flat dumbbell bench press	4 × 8–10	2–3 min
A2	One-arm dumbbell row	4 × 10 per side	2–3 min
B1	Hip thrust	3 × 12	2–3 min
B2	Walking lunge	3 × 10 per leg	2–3 min
C1	Triceps rope pushdown	3 × 15	2 min
C2	Farmer's carry	3 × 40 m	2 min

Progression, and the emergency version

How to get stronger on three days a week

- **Stop 2 reps short of failure** on every set except the last set of A1.
- **Double progression:** when you hit the top of the rep range on every set, add 2.5–5 kg and return to the bottom of the range.
- **Log every session.** If you can't beat last week's numbers on paper, you're not progressing — you're just visiting the gym.
- **Deload every 8 weeks:** same sessions, 60% of the weight, half the sets.

THE 25-MINUTE EMERGENCY SESSION

When the day collapses, do this instead of skipping: **A1 and A2 only, 4 sets each, full 2–4 minute rests.** Cut exercises, never rest. Three heavy well-rested sets beat six rushed ones, and it keeps the streak alive. A shortened session always beats a missed one.

The hotel-room version

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Bodyweight squat, 3 sec down	4 × 20
Push-up (feet elevated to progress)	4 × max–2
Band row	4 × 15
Single-leg RDL	3 × 10 per leg
Reverse lunge	3 × 12 per leg
Plank	3 × 60 s

What three days a year gets you

- **Months 1–3:** strength climbs fast, clothes fit differently, energy and sleep improve
- **Months 4–6:** visible change in shoulders, arms and posture; 3–5 kg of muscle is realistic for a beginner
- **Months 7–12:** the "he's clearly in shape" threshold, and the back pain you'd accepted as permanent is largely gone

Set it up today

- ☐ Three 60-minute blocks in the work calendar, marked busy
- ☐ Sessions saved in a notes app with space to log weights
- ☐ Gym bag packed and by the door
- ☐ A backup slot chosen for each session in case the first is lost

The bar you're actually clearing

One hundred and fifty-six sessions a year. That's what three days a week buys you. Almost nobody who trains 156 times in a year is unhappy with how they look at the end of it — and the programme was never the hard part.